





◀ *Top to bottom: Feb. 11, 2008, Oct. 26, 2009, Apr. 19, 2010*

Red Terror
Feb. 11, 2008

"Indravati is a placid river that flows through south Chhattisgarh, originating from Orissa as a tributary of the Godavari. Many kilometres from Dantewada town, in the Abujmarh region, the river becomes a border—on one side is the waning presence of the BJP government, while in the forests across the Indravati, the CPI (Maoist) reigns supreme. Welcome to the citadel of a revolutionary fantasy in which the enemy is the Indian State....In the remoteness of dispossession, the army of outlaws are at war and the victims are multiplying."

sassinations. It was the country's greatest internal security threat, rooted in governance failure and social exclusion.

What made the decade particularly unsettling was the rise of homegrown terror. Investigations into blasts in Delhi, Jaipur and Ahmedabad revealed that many perpetrators were educated Indian youth radicalised through local grievances and global jihadist narratives. Alienation, perceived injustice and ideological indoctrination produced militants who looked indistinguishable from the 'boys next door'.

The reign of terror between 2005 and 2014 forced India to confront a hard truth. Economic growth and global ambition mean little if the state cannot guarantee the safety of its citizens in buses, bazaars, trains and forests. That lesson, paid for in blood, remains one of the most enduring legacies of the decade. ■



DELHI BOMB BLASTS

Fire and police personnel at the site of the Sarojini Nagar market bomb blasts, Delhi, Oct. 2005

SUMEET INDER SINGH